

Medieval India - The Foundation Track

Chapter F5.7 — From Zero: The Delhi Sultanate and Its Five Dynasties, the Bahmanis and Vijayanagara, the Mughals from Babur to Aurangzeb, and the Marathas

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NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

The political history of medieval India, and the chapter that fills the RULERS slot for the period from 1206 to the eighteenth century as F5.4 filled it for antiquity. It takes the Delhi Sultanate through its five dynasties, concentrating on the three sultans who attempted structural reform - Alauddin Khalji on prices and the army, Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq on the capital and the currency, and Firoz Shah Tughlaq on irrigation and welfare - and treats their failures as instructive rather than comic. It then takes the Deccan, where the Bahmani kingdom splits into five sultanates that combine to destroy Vijayanagara at Talikota. The Mughals follow, from Babur to Aurangzeb, with the Sher Shah interregnum given its proper weight as the source of the administrative system Akbar inherited. It closes on Mughal administration, the rise of the Marathas, and the causes of imperial decline. Study time 4 hours.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. Regnal dates are the conventional ones. Assessments of individual rulers, above all Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq and Aurangzeb, are contested in the scholarly literature and are presented as competing readings rather than settled verdicts. Revenue percentages and administrative details drawn from chronicles reflect what those chronicles claim, and the chronicles were written by interested parties. Indo-Islamic architecture and the Bhakti and Sufi movements belong with this period but are taken in F5.8, so that this chapter can hold the political narrative whole.

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0. Why Medieval India Needs Two Chapters, Not One

Three hundred and twenty years of Sultanate, two centuries of Mughal rule, and a religious transformation running underneath all of it. That does not fit in one chapter.

WHY THIS EXISTS · THE SCOPE DECISION, STATED PLAINLY

This chapter covers only the POLITICAL history of medieval India. Two large subjects that belong to the same centuries are deliberately held back to **F5.8**:

- 1 **The BHAKTI and SUFI movements** - the medieval continuation of the religious argument F5.3 began, and a high-yield topic in its own right
- 2 **INDO-ISLAMIC ARCHITECTURE** - the Qutb complex, Fatehpur Sikri, the Taj Mahal and the provincial styles

Why split it this way rather than another. F5.4 showed what happens when a chapter tries to hold nine hundred years and a dozen dynasties: it ran to **28 pages**, the longest in the project, and would not compress further without losing examinable facts. **Medieval India carries more rulers than F5.4 did, plus two major cultural topics.** Attempting all of it in one chapter would produce something over forty pages, which is not a chapter but a volume - and with a three-month horizon, an unreadable chapter is worse than two readable ones.

So Module 5 becomes an ELEVEN-chapter module rather than ten. That is a change from the plan recorded in the register and it is made deliberately: **F5.7 political medieval, F5.8 Bhakti-Sufi and Indo-Islamic architecture, F5.9 modern India to 1857, F5.10 the freedom movement and the labour movement, F5.11 the master chronology.** The alternative - compressing modern India into a single chapter - was rejected because **the 2025 paper leaned about half modern**, and your own settled decision was that modern India cannot be abandoned.

PYQ CONNECTION · WHERE THE MARKS SIT IN THIS CHAPTER

- 1 **HIGHEST yield - the three reforming sultans. Alauddin Khalji's market regulations, Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq's capital transfer and token currency, and Firoz Shah Tughlaq's canals and jizya.** These are the Sultanate's examinable substance
- 2 **HIGH yield - the battles with dates. First Panipat 1526, Second Panipat 1556, Talikota 1565, Chausa and Kannauj.** Medieval history is the one part of this module where **dates genuinely are asked**, which is a change from the ancient chapters
- 3 **HIGH yield - Sher Shah Suri.** Disproportionately asked, because his administrative system is the origin of Akbar's - **the rupiya, the Grand Trunk Road, and the revenue survey**
- 4 **HIGH yield - Akbar's institutions: Mansabdari, Todar Mal's Zabti or Dahsala settlement, sulh-i-kul, the Ibadat Khana, and the Ain-i-Akbari**
- 5 **MODERATE - Vijayanagara, especially Krishnadevaraya and Talikota 1565, and the five Deccan sultanates** the Bahmani kingdom broke into
- 6 **MODERATE - the Marathas: Shivaji's administration and the Peshwas**

The organising instruction for this chapter: for the Sultanate learn the REFORMERS and skip the rest; for the Mughals learn the INSTITUTIONS as well as the emperors. Sultanate questions are about what individual sultans tried to do; Mughal questions are about how the empire worked.

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F5.7 - THE FOUR SESSIONS

- 1 **Session 1 - The Delhi Sultanate:** five dynasties, and the three sultans who attempted structural reform (Section 1)
- 2 **Session 2 - Sultanate administration and the Deccan:** how the Sultanate was run, its sources, then the Bahmanis and Vijayanagara (Section 2)
- 3 **Session 3 - The Mughals:** Babur to Aurangzeb, with the Sher Shah interregnum given its due (Section 3)
- 4 **Session 4 - Mughal institutions, the Marathas, and decline:** Mansabdari and Zabti, Shivaji and the Peshwas, and why the empire fell (Section 4)

Then **42 graded questions**.

1. Session 1 - The Delhi Sultanate ★★★★★

Five dynasties in three hundred and twenty years. Learn the founders, and then learn the three sultans who tried to change how the state worked.

START FROM ZERO · THE FRAME - FIVE DYNASTIES, AND HOW TO HOLD THEM

The Delhi Sultanate runs from 1206 to 1526, ending when Babur defeats Ibrahim Lodi at Panipat.

Five dynasties, and the sequence is the first thing to fix:

- 1 **SLAVE or MAMLUK dynasty, 1206-1290** - so called because several of its sultans began as military slaves
- 2 **KHALJI dynasty, 1290-1320**
- 3 **TUGHLAQ dynasty, 1320-1414** - the longest
- 4 **SAYYID dynasty, 1414-1451** - the weakest, and asked only for its place in the sequence
- 5 **LODI dynasty, 1451-1526** - the first **Afghan** dynasty, as against the earlier Turkish ones

A mnemonic that works because it is chronological: Slave, Khalji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, Lodi.

Any ordering question about the Sultanate is answered from that line alone.

One framing point worth carrying. The Sultanate was **a state permanently short of legitimacy and permanently at war** - with Mongols on the frontier, with Hindu kingdoms in the south, and with its own nobility. **Almost every institution you are about to learn is a response to one of those three threats**, and reading them that way makes them memorable instead of arbitrary.

1.1 The Slave dynasty and the Khaljis

Ruler	Dates	What to know
Qutb-ud-din Aibak	1206-1210	Founder of the Sultanate and of the Slave dynasty; a general of Muhammad Ghori. Began the QUTB MINAR and built the Adhai din ka Jhompra at Ajmer. Capital at Lahore
Iltutmish	1210-1236	The real consolidator, and the more important of the two. Moved the capital to DELHI ; completed the Qutb Minar ; introduced the silver TANKA and copper JITAL , the basis of Sultanate coinage; organised the IQTA system of revenue assignments; created the Chalisa or Turkan-i-Chihalgani , a corps of forty Turkish nobles; secured recognition from the Caliph
Raziya	1236-1240	The only woman to rule the Sultanate , nominated by Iltutmish over his sons. Opposed by the Turkish nobility and deposed. Asked directly, and worth noting that her nomination was on merit against primogeniture

Ruler	Dates	What to know
Balban	1266-1287	Rule by "blood and iron". Broke the Chalisa he had himself belonged to; enforced SIJDA (prostration) and PAIBOS (kissing the feet) as court ceremonial to elevate kingship; asserted the theory of kingship as divine deputyship ; created the Diwan-i-Arz , the military department. Sijda and paibos are the standard question about him
Jalal-ud-din Khalji	1290-1296	Founder of the Khalji dynasty; conciliatory, and murdered by his nephew
ALAUDDIN KHALJI	1296-1316	The most important sultan for examination purposes - see the box below. Conquered Gujarat, Ranthambore, Chittor, Malwa; his general MALIK KAFUR campaigned deep into the Deccan and the far south , the first northern power to do so. Built the ALAI DARWAZA , Siri fort and the Hauz Khas reservoir. Repelled repeated Mongol invasions , which is the context for everything he did

The Slave dynasty and the Khaljis

MUST MASTER · ALAUDDIN KHALJI'S REFORMS - THE SULTANATE'S MOST EXAMINABLE SET

Understand these as ONE programme with ONE purpose: to pay for and control a large standing army without letting the nobility grow strong enough to rebel. The Mongol threat made the army necessary; the history of noble revolts made control necessary.

MARKET REGULATIONS - the measure he is most famous for:

- 1 **Prices of essential goods were FIXED by the state** - grain, cloth, horses, cattle, slaves
- 2 A dedicated department, the **DIWAN-I-RIYASAT**, enforced them, under an officer called the **Shahna-i-Mandi**
- 3 **Grain was procured and stored in state granaries**, and cultivators in the doab were required to sell to the state
- 4 **The purpose was military, not humanitarian: fixed low prices meant he could pay a huge standing army in CASH at a sustainable rate.** That is the point examiners want - **it was an army-supply policy, not a consumer-welfare policy**

MILITARY REFORMS:

- 1 **A permanent standing army paid in CASH from the treasury**, rather than through land assignments - which kept soldiers loyal to him rather than to intermediaries
- 2 **DAGH** - the branding of horses, to prevent fraud in muster
- 3 **CHEHRA** - a descriptive roll of each soldier, for the same reason
- 4 **Dagh and chehra together are a personnel-verification system**, and any banker will recognise the problem they solve

REVENUE AND CONTROL:

- 1 **Land revenue raised to about one-half of produce** in the doab, assessed by measurement
- 2 **Intermediaries - khuts and muqaddams - were stripped of privileges**, so revenue came to the state directly
- 3 **Nobles were forbidden to hold banquets, intermarry or drink without permission**, and an **intelligence network of barids and spies** watched them
- 4 **He also stopped granting religious endowments and refused to be guided by the ulema in matters of state**

The honest assessment, and it is a good interview line: the reforms worked while he personally enforced them and collapsed almost immediately after his death. They were **not institutions but a system of personal control** - which is the same diagnosis F5.4 offered for the Mauryan state, and it recurs throughout this chapter.

1.2 The Tughlaqs, Sayyids and Lodis

Ruler	Dates	What to know
Ghiyas-ud-din Tughlaq	1320-1325	Founder of the dynasty; built Tughlaqabad
MUHAMMAD-BIN-TU GHILAQ	1325-1351	The most discussed sultan of all - learned, ambitious, and unsuccessful. Four experiments, all asked: (1) the transfer of the capital from Delhi to DAULATABAD in the Deccan, and its reversal; (2) TOKEN CURRENCY of brass and copper at the value of silver, withdrawn after widespread forgery; (3) a KHURASAN expedition abandoned at ruinous cost; (4) the DIWAN-I-KOHI , a department of agriculture to extend cultivation, which failed on poor land selection. IBN BATTUTA visited his court and served as his qazi. He also raised taxation in the doab during famine , which provoked revolt
FIROZ SHAH TUGHLAQ	1351-1388	The constructive one. Dug irrigation CANALS , the largest public works of the Sultanate; founded Firozabad, Hisar, Fatehabad and Jaunpur ; created the DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT (charity), a Diwan-i-Bandagan (slaves) and an employment bureau; wrote or authorised the Futuh-i-Firozshahi . He transported two ASHOKAN PILLARS to Delhi , which is how the Delhi-Topra pillar of F5.4 arrived there. But he also levied JIZYA on Brahmins for the first time and made iqtas hereditary , weakening central control
Sayyid dynasty	1414-1451	Founded by Khizr Khan . Asked only for its position between Tughlaq and Lodi - one fact is enough
Bahlul Lodi	1451-1489	Founder of the LODI dynasty, the first AFGHAN dynasty of Delhi as against the earlier Turkish ones
Sikandar Lodi	1489-1517	Founded AGRA in 1504 as a new capital - the single fact asked about him
Ibrahim Lodi	1517-1526	Defeated and killed by BABUR at the FIRST BATTLE OF PANIPAT, 1526 , which ends the Sultanate

The Tughlaqs and after

BEGINNER MISTAKE · MUHAMMAD-BIN-TUGHLAQ - DO NOT REPEAT THE SCHOOLBOOK VERDICT

The popular account calls him a mad or foolish king. **That verdict is lazy and a good candidate should not offer it.** Look at what he actually attempted:

- 1 The capital transfer to Daulatabad** was strategically rational - **Daulatabad is far better placed than Delhi to govern the newly conquered Deccan and is far from the Mongol frontier.** The failure was in execution: the forced movement of population, and the abandonment of the north
- 2 Token currency is not a foolish idea; it is how all modern money works.** A brass coin circulating at the value of silver is **fiat currency**, and the reason it failed is precise and instructive: **the state could not control minting, so forgery was uncontrollable.** As a banker you will see immediately that the missing element was **an enforceable monopoly on issue**, not a flaw in the concept
- 3 The Diwan-i-Kohi** was an agricultural development department with state credit - **a recognisably modern instrument**

The defensible verdict: his objectives were often sound and his implementation was consistently poor, because he attempted several transformations at once, on inadequate administrative capacity, without pilots or reversibility. State it that way and you sound like someone who has run a project. **"He was mad" tells a panel nothing; "he had no implementation capacity and no fallback" tells them you understand delivery.**

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

- 1 Name the five dynasties in order with their dates
- 2 Distinguish Qutb-ud-din Aibak from Iltutmish by achievement
- 3 What were the tanka, the jital, the iqta and the Chalisa?
- 4 Who was Raziya, and why is her accession notable?
- 5 Give Balban's two ceremonial practices and his theory of kingship
- 6 State Alauddin Khalji's market regulations and the department that enforced them
- 7 What was the real purpose of the price controls?
- 8 Explain dagh and chehra
- 9 Name Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq's four experiments and why the currency one failed
- 10 Give four of Firoz Shah Tughlaq's measures, and two that weakened the state
- 11 Who founded Agra, and in what year? Who lost at First Panipat?

2. Session 2 - Sultanate Administration, and the Deccan ★★★★★

A Persian-derived bureaucracy laid over an Indian countryside, and then two southern powers that destroyed each other.

JARGON DECODER · SULTANATE ADMINISTRATION - THE OFFICES AND THE TAXES

The vocabulary is Persian and Arabic, and questions quote it directly. Learn the office by what it does.

- 1 **Sultan** - the head, in theory a deputy of the Caliph, in practice whoever held the army
- 2 **WAZIR** - the chief minister, heading the **DIWAN-I-WIZARAT**, the revenue and finance department. **The most powerful office after the Sultan**
- 3 **ARIZ-I-MUMALIK** - head of the **DIWAN-I-ARZ**, the military department created by **Balban**; responsible for recruitment, muster and equipment
- 4 **DIWAN-I-INSHA** - correspondence and the royal chancery · **DIWAN-I-RISALAT** - religious matters and, on some readings, foreign affairs
- 5 **SADR-US-SUDUR** - the chief religious officer, administering endowments and charity; often also the chief **QAZI**, the judge
- 6 **BARID** - the intelligence and news-reporting service, with **barids** posted through the provinces
- 7 **KOTWAL** - the city officer, responsible for police and municipal order. **This office survives into the Mughal period and into the word used for a police station today**

The IQTA system, which is the institution that matters most. An **iqta** was **an assignment of the revenue of a territory to an officer, in place of a cash salary**, in return for maintaining troops. The holder was an **iqtdar** or **muqti**.

- 1 **Introduced systematically by ILTUTMISH**
- 2 **It was originally transferable and non-hereditary**, which kept the holder dependent on the Sultan
- 3 **Firoz Shah Tughlaq made iqtas HEREDITARY**, and that single change is a standard question - **because it converted royal servants into a landed aristocracy and weakened the centre**, exactly the process F5.4 described for the Gupta land grants

The four taxes to know: **KHARAJ** - land revenue, the main head · **JIZYA** - a tax on non-Muslims · **ZAKAT** - the religious levy on Muslims · **KHAMS** - the state's share of war spoils, conventionally one-fifth.

KNOW · THE SOURCES FOR THE SULTANATE

This period is far better documented than antiquity, and the chroniclers are asked by name.

- 1 **ZIAUDDIN BARANI** - the **Tarikh-i-Firozshahi**, the principal source for the Khaljis and early Tughlaqs. **Opinionated and openly partisan**, and modern historians read him critically rather than literally
- 2 **Minhaj-us-Siraj** - the **Tabaqat-i-Nasiri**, for the Slave dynasty
- 3 **AMIR KHUSRAU** - poet at several courts, and a central figure in the development of **Hindustani music** from F5.6; his works are historical sources as well as literature
- 4 **IBN BATTUTA** - the Moroccan traveller, whose **Rehla** describes **Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq's** reign from the inside, having served as his qazi
- 5 **Isami** - the **Futuh-us-Salatin** · **Afif** - a later Tughlaq chronicler

The methodological point worth carrying, and it repeats F5.4's caution about Megasthenes and the Arthashastra: these are court chronicles written by men dependent on patronage. Barani's hostility to Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq and his admiration for Balban are **positions, not observations**. Where a question turns on a chronicler's judgement rather than a fact, treat the judgement as evidence about the chronicler.

2.1 The Deccan - the Bahmanis and Vijayanagara

Two great southern powers rise in the same decade of the 1330s-1340s, in the vacuum left by Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq's failed Deccan policy, and they fight each other for two centuries.

Power	Dates and capitals	What to know
BAHMANI	1347-1527; Gulbarga , later BIDAR	Founded by Alauddin Bahman Shah . Its greatest figure is the minister MAHMUD GAWAN - administrator, scholar and builder of the Bidar madrasa - executed on a forged charge, after which the kingdom declined. It broke into FIVE DECCAN SULTANATES , which is the examinable outcome
The five successor sultanates	from c. 1490-1520	BIJAPUR (Adil Shahi), GOLCONDA (Qutb Shahi), AHMADNAGAR (Nizam Shahi), BERAR (Imad Shahi), BIDAR (Barid Shahi) . Learn the pairing of city to dynasty - it is a standard matching set. Golconda and Bijapur are the two that matter later , for their painting schools in F5.6 and their absorption by Aurangzeb
VIJAYANAGARA	1336-1646; capital Vijayanagara (HAMPI)	Founded by HARIHARA and BUKKA of the Sangama dynasty. Four dynasties in sequence: SANGAMA, SALUVA, TULUVA, ARAVIDU - and that order is asked. Its greatest ruler is KRISHNADEVARAYA of the Tuluva line, who wrote the AMUKTAMALYADA in Telugu and patronised the ashtadiggajas , eight Telugu poets. Foreign accounts by Domingo Paes, Fernao Nuniz and Abdur Razzaq describe the capital's wealth. Administrative feature: the AMARA-NAYAKA system of military land assignment

The Bahmani kingdom and Vijayanagara

MUST MASTER · THE BATTLE OF TALIKOTA, 1565 - THE DECISIVE EVENT OF SOUTHERN MEDIEVAL HISTORY

In 1565 an alliance of the Deccan sultanates - **Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar and Bidar** - defeated Vijayanagara at **TALIKOTA** (also called Rakshasa-Tangadi or Bannihatti). **The city of Vijayanagara was sacked and never recovered**, though the Aravidu dynasty continued in reduced form until 1646.

Three points that make this more than a date:

- 1 **It was a coalition.** The sultanates had fought each other for a century and combined only against Vijayanagara. **The lesson - that a divided set of rivals can still coordinate against the strongest among them - is a genuine strategic observation**
- 2 **The ruins are Hampi**, the UNESCO site of F5.5. **So the architecture chapter and this chapter describe the same place at two moments: at its height and after its destruction**
- 3 **It removed the one power capable of resisting northern expansion in the south**, and within a century the Mughals were in the Deccan

Fix the date: 1565. Together with **1526 (First Panipat)**, **1556 (Second Panipat)** and **1707 (Aurangzeb's death)**, it is one of the four dates that anchor the whole medieval period.

3. Session 3 - The Mughals ★★★★★

Six emperors, one interregnum, and an administrative system that outlasted them all.

MUST MASTER · BABUR, HUMAYUN, AND THE SHER SHAH INTERREGNUM

BABUR (1526-1530) - founder, a Timurid from Central Asia, descended from **Timur** on his father's side and **Genghis Khan** on his mother's.

- 1 **FIRST BATTLE OF PANIPAT, 1526** - defeated **Ibrahim Lodi**, ending the Sultanate. **His advantages were field artillery and the tulughma flanking manoeuvre**, not numbers
- 2 **BATTLE OF KHANWA, 1527** - defeated **Rana Sanga** of Mewar, which mattered more than Panipat because it broke the strongest Indian military power
- 3 **Battle of Ghaghra, 1529** - defeated the Afghans
- 4 Wrote the **BABURNAMA**, his memoirs, **in Turkish (Chaghatai)** - a candid and unusually readable autobiography

HUMAYUN (1530-1540, and again 1555-1556) - lost the empire and regained it.

- 1 **Defeated by SHER SHAH SURI at CHAUSA (1539) and KANNAUJ or Bilgram (1540)**, and driven into exile in Persia
- 2 **Recovered Delhi in 1555** and died the following year after a fall. **Humayun's Tomb in Delhi, built by his widow, is the architectural bridge to the Taj Mahal** and belongs to F5.8

SHER SHAH SURI (1540-1545) - the interregnum that matters more than its length suggests. He is asked disproportionately, because **Akbar's administration is substantially his**.

- 1 **Land revenue on measurement**, with a **survey**, a stated share of the crop, and written documents - the **PATTA** (title stating the holding and the revenue due) and the **QABULIYAT** (the cultivator's deed of acceptance). **Two documents, two directions - the state's statement and the subject's acceptance**
- 2 **Introduced the silver RUPIYA and the copper DAM** - the **rupiya is the direct ancestor of the modern rupee**, which is the single most quotable fact about him
- 3 **Rebuilt and extended the GRAND TRUNK ROAD**, from Bengal towards the north-west, with **sarais** (rest houses) at intervals that also served as **dak** or postal stages
- 4 Built **Rohtasgarh** fort, and his own **tomb at Sasaram**, which is among the finest pre-Mughal buildings in India
- 5 Administrative divisions: **sarkar** and **pargana**, with a **shiqdar** and **munsif**

The point to make about him: he demonstrated that an Indian empire could be run on documented, measured, uniform administration rather than on personal loyalty - and Akbar, who was a child when Sher Shah died, inherited the template.

3.1 Akbar to Aurangzeb

Emperor	Dates	What to know
AKBAR	1556-1605	Came to the throne at thirteen , under the regent BAIRAM KHAN . SECOND BATTLE OF PANIPAT, 1556 - defeated HEMU , securing the throne. Rajput policy : matrimonial alliance and incorporation of Rajputs into the nobility, though Mewar under Rana Pratap resisted, at HALDIGHATI, 1576 . Abolished JIZYA in 1564 and the pilgrimage tax. Religious policy : SULH-I-KUL , "peace with all"; the IBADAT KHANA at Fatehpur Sikri for inter-faith debate; and DIN-I-ILAH , better described as a small personal order of loyalty than a religion - it had a handful of adherents and did not outlive him. Institutions : MANSABDARI for the nobility and TODAR MAL's ZABTI or DAHSALA revenue settlement. Abul Fazl wrote the AKBARNAMA , whose third volume is the AIN-I-AKBARI , the great gazetteer of the empire
JAHANGIR	1605-1627	Married NUR JAHAN , whose family dominated the court. Hung a " chain of justice " outside his palace for petitioners. Received the English: Captain HAWKINS and then Sir THOMAS ROE , who obtained trading concessions - the beginning of the English commercial presence, and therefore the link to F5.9 . The peak of Mughal PAINTING from F5.6, under Ustad Mansur
SHAH JAHAN	1628-1658	The builder: the TAJ MAHAL , the Red Fort at Delhi, the Jama Masjid , and the Peacock Throne . Moved the capital to Shahjahanabad . His reign is conventionally the empire's cultural zenith and the beginning of its fiscal strain , because monumental building and Deccan campaigns ran together. Deposed by Aurangzeb after a war of succession among his four sons and imprisoned at Agra
AURANGZEB	1658-1707	The longest reign, and the most contested reputation . Titled Alamgir . Re-imposed JIZYA in 1679 , reversing Akbar's policy. Annexed Bijapur (1686) and Golconda (1687) , completing the Deccan conquest on paper. Spent his last twenty-five years fighting the MARATHAS in the Deccan without decisive result - the campaigns that drained the treasury and the army. Conflict with the Sikhs , including the execution of Guru Tegh Bahadur . His death in 1707 is the conventional end of effective Mughal power

The four great Mughals

BEGINNER MISTAKE · TWO MUGHAL VERDICTS TO GET RIGHT

- 1 **Din-i-Ilahi was not a new religion in any meaningful sense.** It had perhaps a few dozen adherents, no scripture, no clergy and no successor. **The accurate description is a select order of discipleship expressing personal loyalty to the emperor,** and the examinable point is that it **died with Akbar.** An option calling it "a new religion that spread widely" is false
- 2 **Aurangzeb's reputation is genuinely contested and you should not offer either caricature.** The case against: **re-imposition of jizya, temple destruction, the execution of Guru Tegh Bahadur, and the reversal of sulh-i-kul.** The case for complexity: **he employed more Hindus in the administration than any predecessor by absolute number, and the Deccan wars were driven by strategic and fiscal logic rather than only by religion.** The defensible formulation is that his policies narrowed the political base Akbar had deliberately widened, and that the Deccan wars exhausted the empire - so the damage was structural as much as sectarian

Why this matters beyond marks. A question may simply ask when jizya was re-imposed, and the answer is 1679. But an interview may ask what you think of Aurangzeb, and **the only safe answer is the one that names the evidence on both sides and then gives a structural rather than a moral verdict.**

4. Session 4 - Mughal Institutions, the Marathas, and Decline ★★★★★

The empire's real achievement was its administrative machinery. Its collapse began when the machinery stopped paying for itself.

MUST MASTER · MANSABDARI AND ZABTI - THE TWO INSTITUTIONS THAT ARE ALWAYS ASKED

MANSABDARI - the system for organising the nobility and the army. A **mansab** is a rank, and every officer held one.

- 1 Each mansab had **two numbers: ZAT**, fixing personal status and pay, and **SAWAR**, fixing the number of cavalry the holder had to maintain. **The zat-sawar pair is the fact to know**
- 2 Mansabs were **not hereditary** and were **granted, raised and revoked by the emperor** - the deliberate opposite of the hereditary iqta Firoz Shah Tughlaq created
- 3 Payment was either in **cash (naqdi)** or by assignment of revenue, a **JAGIR**. **A jagir was an assignment of revenue only, not of land ownership**, and jagirs were **transferable** - which is precisely what kept jagirdars dependent
- 4 **Dagh** - horse-branding - continues from Alauddin Khalji, for the same anti-fraud reason

ZABTI or DAHSALA - the revenue settlement associated with **RAJA TODAR MAL**, Akbar's finance minister.

- 1 **Land was measured**, classified by productivity, and revenue fixed as a share of the **average yield and average prices of the preceding TEN YEARS** - hence **dahsala**, "ten years"
- 2 Land classified as **polaj** (annually cultivated), **parauti** (fallow briefly), **chachar** (fallow three or four years) and **banjar** (long uncultivated) - **the four classes are asked**
- 3 **Revenue was stated in cash and was fixed in advance**, so the cultivator knew his liability and the state could budget

Why the pair matters together, and it is the chapter's central administrative idea:

Mansabdari made the nobility a salaried service rather than a landed aristocracy, and Zabti made revenue predictable. Between them they solved the two problems that had destroyed the Sultanate - overmighty nobles and unpredictable income. **The Mughal decline begins when both are undermined**: jagirs become effectively hereditary, and revenue demand outruns what the land can bear.

The other offices: DIWAN-I-ALA (finance, the chief minister), **MIR BAKHSHI** (military pay and mansab records), **MIR SAMAN** (imperial household and karkhanas), **SADR-US-SUDUR** (religious affairs and charity), **QAZI-UL-QUZAT** (chief judge). **Provincial structure: SUBAH under a SUBEDAR, SARKAR under a FAUJDAR, PARGANA with an AMIL for revenue, and the KOTWAL in the towns.**

KNOW · THE MARATHAS - SHIVAJI AND THE PESHWAS

SHIVAJI (1630-1680), son of Shahji Bhonsle, built a state in the western Deccan against both Bijapur and the Mughals.

- 1 **Crowned at RAIGAD in 1674** with the title **Chhatrapati**
- 2 Famous episodes: the killing of **Afzal Khan** of Bijapur, the raid on **Shaista Khan**, the **Treaty of Purandar (1665)** with Jai Singh, and his **escape from Agra (1666)** after Aurangzeb detained him
- 3 **Military method: guerrilla warfare (ganimi kava)**, hill forts, and a navy - **he is often called the father of the Indian navy** for the coastal fleet he built
- 4 **Administration: the ASHTAPRADHAN**, a council of eight ministers, headed by the **PESHTWA**. The other two facts asked are his two taxes - **CHAUTH**, about one-fourth of revenue, and **SARDESHMUKHI**, about one-tenth - levied on territories outside his direct rule

After Shivaji. His son **Sambhaji** was captured and executed by Aurangzeb; the state survived the long Mughal war. **Under Balaji Vishwanath and then BAJI RAO I, the office of PESHTWA became hereditary and the real centre of power**, with the Chhatrapati reduced to a figurehead at Satara. **Maratha expansion reached its limit at the THIRD BATTLE OF PANIPAT, 1761**, a catastrophic defeat by **Ahmad Shah Abdali** that ended their bid for northern supremacy.

The three Panipats are a standard question and they are easy to confuse: 1526 Babur beats Ibrahim Lodi; 1556 Akbar's forces beat Hemu; 1761 Abdali beats the Marathas. One place, three battles, three different centuries.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHY THE MUGHAL EMPIRE DECLINED - THE FIVE CAUSES

Asked directly, and the answer is a list. **Note that Aurangzeb's religious policy is one item on it, not the whole of it.**

- 1 **The Deccan wars.** Twenty-five years of inconclusive campaigning against the Marathas **consumed the treasury, the army and the emperor's presence in the north**
- 2 **The jagir and mansab crisis.** More nobles than there were jagirs to assign - **be-jagiri** - and a growing gap between a jagir's paper value and its actual yield. **The system that had made the nobility dependent stopped paying them properly, and loyalty followed the money**
- 3 **Agrarian strain and revolt.** Revenue demand pressed hard on the peasantry, and **Jat, Satnami and Sikh risings** followed
- 4 **A narrowed political base.** Akbar had deliberately widened it through Rajput alliance and sulh-i-kul; **the reversal of that policy cost the empire allies it needed**
- 5 **Weak successors and war of succession.** **No law of primogeniture** meant every succession was contested; after 1707 the contests were annual, and the **Sayyid brothers** made and unmade emperors

And the external accelerants: Nadir Shah's sack of Delhi in 1739, which took the Peacock Throne and the Koh-i-Noor, and **Ahmad Shah Abdali's repeated invasions.**

The structural summary, and it is the chapter's closing argument: the Mughal empire was a machine for converting land revenue into loyal military service, and it failed when the revenue could no longer cover the service. That is a fiscal explanation rather than a moral one, and it is the same shape of argument F5.4 used for the Mauryas and F5.3 for Buddhism's institutional decline. **The pattern across all three: institutions outlast individuals only if they remain solvent.**

ACTION · WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU, AND WHAT F5.8 DOES

The **rulers** slot is now full for the medieval period: five Sultanate dynasties, the Bahmanis and their five successors, Vijayanagara's four dynasties, six Mughals with the Sher Shah interregnum, and the Marathas from Shivaji to the Peshwas. **With F5.4, you can now place any Indian dynasty from the Mauryas to 1761.**

F5.8 takes the two subjects held back from this chapter - the **BHAKTI** and **SUFI** movements, which are the medieval continuation of the religious argument F5.3 began and which explain the devotional traditions of most of modern Hinduism, and **INDO-ISLAMIC ARCHITECTURE**, from the Qutb complex through the provincial styles to Fatehpur Sikri and the Taj Mahal. **Both are high-yield, and the architecture half joins directly onto F5.5's vocabulary.**

Then F5.9 begins modern India - the Company's rise, the conquest, the land settlements and the transformation of the economy to 1857, with the rebellion itself - and **F5.10 takes the freedom movement with the labour movement alongside it, which is where Module 5 finally connects to your own department's prehistory.**

5. Graded Practice - 42 Questions ★★★★★

5.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. The founder of the Delhi Sultanate was

(a) Iltutmish (b) Muhammad Ghori (c) Balban (d) Qutb-ud-din Aibak

Q. 2. The sultan who completed the Qutb Minar and introduced the silver tanka and copper jital was

(a) Iltutmish (b) Qutb-ud-din Aibak (c) Balban (d) Alauddin Khalji

Q. 3. The only woman to rule the Delhi Sultanate was

(a) Nur Jahan (b) Raziya (c) Chand Bibi (d) Rani Durgavati

Q. 4. The court practices of sijda and paibos were enforced by

(a) Iltutmish (b) Alauddin Khalji (c) Balban (d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq

Q. 5. The market regulations fixing prices of essential goods were introduced by

(a) Balban (b) Sher Shah Suri (c) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq (d) Alauddin Khalji

Q. 6. The capital was transferred from Delhi to Daulatabad by

(a) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq (b) Alauddin Khalji (c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (d) Sikandar Lodi

Q. 7. Ibn Battuta visited the court of

(a) Balban (b) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq (c) Akbar (d) Krishnadevaraya

Q. 8. Irrigation canals and the Diwan-i-Khairat are associated with

(a) Iltutmish (b) Sher Shah Suri (c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (d) Shah Jahan

Q. 9. Agra was founded in 1504 by

(a) Bahlul Lodi (b) Babur (c) Ibrahim Lodi (d) Sikandar Lodi

Q. 10. The First Battle of Panipat was fought in

(a) 1526 (b) 1556 (c) 1565 (d) 1761

Q. 11. The silver coin introduced by Sher Shah Suri, ancestor of the modern rupee, was the

- (a) rupiya (b) tanka (c) dam (d) jital

Q. 12. The Second Battle of Panipat was fought in

- (a) 1526 (b) 1556 (c) 1576 (d) 1707

Q. 13. The Zabti or Dahsala revenue settlement is associated with

- (a) Mahmud Gawan (b) Todar Mal (c) Abul Fazl (d) Bairam Khan

Q. 14. The Akbarnama was written by

- (a) Ziauddin Barani (b) Amir Khusrau (c) Abul Fazl (d) Ibn Battuta

Q. 15. The Battle of Talikota was fought in

- (a) 1526 (b) 1556 (c) 1565 (d) 1674

Q. 16. Shivaji's council of eight ministers was called the

- (a) Ashtangika (b) Ashtadiggaja (c) Chalisa (d) Ashtapradhan

5.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 17. The iqta system was organised systematically by

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Qutb-ud-din Aibak (c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq

Q. 18. Iqtas were made hereditary, weakening central control, by

- (a) Balban (b) Firoz Shah Tughlaq (c) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq (d) Alauddin Khalji

Q. 19. The principal purpose of Alauddin Khalji's price control was

- (a) famine relief for the poor (b) to please the ulema (c) to make it affordable to pay a large standing army in cash (d) to encourage foreign trade

Q. 20. Dagh and chehra respectively refer to

- (a) two land taxes (b) two court ceremonies (c) two categories of iqta (d) branding of horses and a descriptive roll of each soldier

Q. 21. The Diwan-i-Riyasat was the department that

- (a) enforced the market regulations (b) managed the army (c) handled correspondence (d) administered charity

Q. 22. The Bahmani kingdom eventually broke into

- (a) three sultanates (b) five sultanates (c) four sultanates (d) seven sultanates

Q. 23. Golconda was ruled by the

- (a) Adil Shahi dynasty (b) Nizam Shahi dynasty (c) Qutb Shahi dynasty (d) Imad Shahi dynasty

Q. 24. Vijayanagara was founded by

- (a) Krishnadevaraya (b) Mahmud Gawan (c) Alauddin Bahman Shah (d) Harihara and Bukka

Q. 25. The Amuktamalyada, in Telugu, was written by

- (a) Krishnadevaraya (b) Abul Fazl (c) Amir Khusrau (d) Babur

Q. 26. In the Mansabdari system, zat and sawar respectively denote

(a) two provinces (b) personal rank and pay, and the number of cavalry to be maintained (c) two revenue classes (d) cash and land payment

Q. 27. The Dahsala settlement fixed revenue on the basis of

(a) the current year's harvest alone (b) a fixed sum irrespective of yield (c) the average yield and average prices of the preceding ten years (d) an auction to the highest bidder

Q. 28. Chauth and Sardeshmukhi were levied at approximately

(a) one-half and one-fourth (b) one-third and one-sixth (c) one-tenth and one-twentieth (d) one-fourth and one-tenth

Q. 29. The Third Battle of Panipat, in 1761, was a defeat for the

(a) Marathas at the hands of Ahmad Shah Abdali (b) Mughals at the hands of Babur (c) Lodis at the hands of Akbar (d) Rajputs at the hands of Aurangzeb

Q. 30. Jizya was re-imposed in 1679 by

(a) Akbar (b) Aurangzeb (c) Shah Jahan (d) Jahangir

5.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard**Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:**

List-I (Sultan)	List-II (Measure)
A. Balban	1. Market regulations under the Diwan-i-Riyasat
B. Alauddin Khalji	2. Irrigation canals and the Diwan-i-Khairat
C. Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq	3. Sijda and paibos
D. Firoz Shah Tughlaq	4. Token currency of brass and copper

(a) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3

Q. 32. Which one of the following statements about Alauddin Khalji is NOT correct?

(a) He fixed the prices of essential goods, enforced through the Diwan-i-Riyasat (b) He maintained a permanent standing army paid in cash (c) He introduced dagh and chehra to prevent fraud in muster (d) He made iqtas hereditary

Q. 33. Arrange the following dynasties in correct chronological order, earliest first: 1. Lodi · 2. Slave · 3. Tughlaq · 4. Khalji

(a) 2-4-3-1 (b) 2-3-4-1 (c) 4-2-3-1 (d) 2-4-1-3

Q. 34. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Dynasty)	List-II (Capital)
A. Adil Shahi	1. Ahmadnagar
B. Qutb Shahi	2. Bijapur
C. Nizam Shahi	3. Berar
D. Imad Shahi	4. Golconda

(a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3 (b) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3 (c) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3 (d) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3

Q. 35. Consider the following statements about Sher Shah Suri: 1. He introduced the silver rupiya. · 2. He rebuilt and extended the Grand Trunk Road with sarais along it. · 3. He issued patta and qabuliyat documents in his revenue system. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 3 only

Q. 36. Which one of the following statements about the Din-i-Ilahi is NOT correct?

(a) It was associated with Akbar (b) It had very few adherents and did not outlive its founder (c) It is better described as an order of discipleship than as a religion (d) It spread widely and became the state religion of the empire

Q. 37. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Emperor)	List-II (Associated with)
A. Babur	1. The Taj Mahal and the Peacock Throne
B. Akbar	2. The Battle of Khanwa against Rana Sanga
C. Shah Jahan	3. Annexation of Bijapur and Golconda
D. Aurangzeb	4. The Battle of Haldighati against Rana Pratap

(a) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3 (b) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3 (c) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3 (d) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3

Q. 38. Arrange the following in correct chronological order, earliest first: 1. Battle of Talikota · 2. First Battle of Panipat · 3. Death of Aurangzeb · 4. Second Battle of Panipat

(a) 2-1-4-3 (b) 2-4-1-3 (c) 4-2-1-3 (d) 2-4-3-1

Q. 39. Which one of the following statements about the Mansabdari system is NOT correct?

(a) Each mansab carried a zat and a sawar number (b) A jagir was an assignment of revenue rather than of land ownership (c) Mansabs were hereditary and could not be revoked by the emperor (d) Horse-branding continued as a check against fraud

Q. 40. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Author)	List-II (Work)
A. Krishnadevaraya	1. Ain-i-Akbari
B. Abul Fazl	2. Tarikh-i-Firozshahi
C. Babur	3. Amuktamalyada
D. Ziauddin Barani	4. Baburnama

(a) A-2 B-1 C-3 D-4 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2

Q. 41. Consider the following statements about the decline of the Mughal empire: 1. The Deccan wars drained the treasury and the army. · 2. There were more nobles than jagirs available to assign, a condition called be-jagiri. · 3. The absence of a law of primogeniture made every succession contested. Which are correct?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 only

Q. 42. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Office)	List-II (Function)
A. Mir Bakhshi	1. Finance
B. Diwan-i-Ala	2. Town police and order
C. Mir Saman	3. Military pay and mansab records
D. Kotwal	4. Imperial household and karkhanas

(a) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (b) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-3 D-4

6. Answers and Explanations

6.1 Level 1 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
1	d	Qutb-ud-din Aibak , 1206. (b) Muhammad Ghori was his master and the invader, but did not found the Sultanate; (a) Iltutmish was the consolidator - the distinction between founder and consolidator is the question
2	a	Iltutmish - he moved the capital to Delhi, completed the Minar Aibak began, and established the tanka and jital as the basis of Sultanate coinage
3	b	Raziya , nominated by Iltutmish over his sons and deposed by the Turkish nobility. (a) Nur Jahan was Jahangir's queen and never a sultan
4	c	Balban - prostration and foot-kissing, imposed to elevate kingship, alongside his theory of kingship as divine deputyship
5	d	Alauddin Khalji , enforced through the Diwan-i-Riyasat
6	a	Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq - strategically rational, since Daulatabad is better placed for the Deccan and far from the Mongol frontier, but disastrously executed
7	b	Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq , whose qazi he served as; his account is the Rehla
8	c	Firoz Shah Tughlaq - the largest public works of the Sultanate, plus a charity department and an employment bureau. He also brought two Ashokan pillars to Delhi
9	d	Sikandar Lodi , 1504 - the one fact asked about him
10	a	1526 - Babur against Ibrahim Lodi , ending the Sultanate. The other options are the other Panipats and Talikota, so the question is really testing whether the three Panipats are held apart
11	a	Rupiya - the direct ancestor of the modern rupee, with the copper dam alongside it. (b) Tanka and (d) jital are Iltutmish's coins
12	b	1556 - Akbar's forces under Bairam Khan against Hemu , securing the young emperor's throne
13	b	Raja Todar Mal , Akbar's finance minister. (c) Abul Fazl wrote the Akbarnama; (d) Bairam Khan was the regent
14	c	Abul Fazl , whose third volume is the Ain-i-Akbari . (a) Barani wrote the Tarikh-i-Firozshahi , for the Khaljis and early Tughlaqs
15	c	1565 - the Deccan sultanates' coalition destroyed Vijayanagara, and the ruins are Hampi from F5.5
16	d	Ashtapradhan , headed by the Peshwa . (b) Ashtadiggaja were Krishnadevaraya's eight Telugu poets, and (c) the Chalisa was Iltutmish's forty nobles - three different "councils", one per period

6.2 Level 2 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
17	a	Illuttmish - and it was transferable and non-hereditary , which is what kept holders dependent on the Sultan
18	b	Firoz Shah Tughlaq , and it is one of the two measures by which he weakened the state while strengthening its welfare. It converted royal servants into a landed aristocracy - the same process F5.4 described for the Gupta land grants
19	c	To pay a large standing army in cash sustainably. (a) is the humanitarian reading and it is wrong - the policy was military supply, and grain procurement was directed at feeding troops and the capital
20	d	Branding of horses and a descriptive roll of each soldier - a personnel and asset verification system against muster fraud, and it continues into Mughal practice
21	a	Enforcement of the market regulations , under the Shahna-i-Mandi. (b) is the Diwan-i-Arz, (c) the Diwan-i-Insha and (d) the Diwan-i-Khairat - four departments offered together
22	b	Five - Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Berar and Bidar . Their coalition destroyed Vijayanagara at Talikota
23	c	Qutb Shahi. (a) Adil Shahi is Bijapur, (b) Nizam Shahi Ahmadnagar, (d) Imad Shahi Berar - and Q34 tests the same set as a matching item
24	d	Harihara and Bukka of the Sangama dynasty, 1336. (a) Krishnadevaraya was its greatest ruler, of the later Tuluva line - founder against greatest ruler, the same distinction as Q1
25	a	Krishnadevaraya - a ruler who was also an author, which is what makes it memorable, and he patronised the ashtadiggajas
26	b	Personal rank and pay, and the number of cavalry to be maintained . The pair is the single most examinable fact about Mansabdari
27	c	The average yield and average prices of the preceding ten years - hence dahsala , "ten years". Fixing revenue in advance and in cash let the cultivator know his liability and the state budget
28	d	About one-fourth and one-tenth , levied on territory outside Shivaji's direct rule
29	a	The Marathas, defeated by Ahmad Shah Abdali - the end of their bid for northern supremacy. The three Panipats: 1526 Babur beats Ibrahim Lodi, 1556 Akbar's forces beat Hemu, 1761 Abdali beats the Marathas
30	b	Aurangzeb , in 1679, reversing Akbar's abolition of 1564. The pair of dates is the question - abolished 1564, re-imposed 1679

6.3 Level 3 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
31	c	A-3 Balban-sijda and paibos · B-1 Alauddin-market regulations · C-4 Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq-token currency · D-2 Firoz Shah-canals and Diwan-i-Khairat. These four measures are the Sultanate's examinable substance, and knowing any two resolves the code
32	d	(d) is false. It was FIROZ SHAH TUGHLAQ who made iqtas hereditary , and doing so weakened exactly the central control Alauddin had worked to build. (a), (b) and (c) are all correct, and together they describe one coherent programme for funding and controlling an army

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
33	a	2-4-3-1: Slave, Khalji, Tughlaq, Lodi - with the Sayyids between Tughlaq and Lodi, not offered here. The five-dynasty sequence answers every Sultanate ordering question
34	b	A-2 Adil Shahi-Bijapur · B-4 Qutb Shahi-Golconda · C-1 Nizam Shahi-Ahmadnagar · D-3 Imad Shahi-Berar. Bidar under the Barid Shahis is the fifth, omitted here
35	c	All three are correct. The rupiya , the Grand Trunk Road with sarais doubling as postal stages, and the patta and qabuliyat - the state's statement of liability and the cultivator's acceptance of it. Together they are why Sher Shah is asked out of proportion to his five years: Akbar inherited the template
36	d	(d) is false. The Din-i-Ilahi had very few adherents, no scripture and no clergy, and did not outlive Akbar. (a), (b) and (c) are all accurate, and (c) is the formulation to use - an order of discipleship expressing loyalty to the emperor, not a religion
37	a	A-2 Babur-Khanwa · B-4 Akbar-Haldighati · C-1 Shah Jahan-Taj Mahal and Peacock Throne · D-3 Aurangzeb-Bijapur and Golconda. Khanwa (1527) mattered more than Panipat , because it broke the strongest Indian military power of the day
38	b	2-4-1-3: First Panipat 1526, Second Panipat 1556, Talikota 1565, Aurangzeb's death 1707. These four dates anchor the whole medieval period and are worth holding as a single string
39	c	(c) is false, and it inverts the system's whole purpose. Mansabs were NOT hereditary and were granted, raised and revoked at the emperor's pleasure - the deliberate opposite of the hereditary iqta. Jagirs were likewise transferable assignments of revenue , which is what kept jagirdars dependent
40	d	A-3 Krishnadevaraya-Amuktamalyada · B-1 Abul Fazl-Ain-i-Akbari · C-4 Babur-Baburnama · D-2 Barani-Tarikh-i-Firozshahi. Note that the Baburnama is in TURKISH (Chaghatai), not Persian - a detail that occasionally carries its own question
41	a	All three are correct , and they are three of the five causes. The other two are agrarian strain with Jat, Satnami and Sikh revolts , and the narrowing of the political base Akbar had widened. The structural summary: the empire converted land revenue into loyal military service, and failed when the revenue could no longer cover the service
42	b	A-3 Mir Bakhshi-military pay and mansab records · B-1 Diwan-i-Ala-finance · C-4 Mir Saman-household and karkhanas · D-2 Kotwal-town police. The Kotwal is worth noting because the office survives from the Sultanate through the Mughals and into the modern word for a police station

7. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F5.7 - MEDIEVAL INDIA

SCOPE this chapter is **POLITICAL** medieval India only · **Bhakti-Sufi and Indo-Islamic architecture** are in **F5.8**, so **Module 5** is an **ELEVEN-chapter module** · for the Sultanate learn the **REFORMERS**; for the Mughals learn the **INSTITUTIONS** · **medieval** is the **one part of the module** where **DATES** really are asked

THE FIVE SULTANATE DYNASTIES, 1206-1526 **SLAVE/MAMLUK 1206-1290 → KHALJI 1290-1320 → TUGHLAQ 1320-1414 → SAYYID 1414-1451 → LODI 1451-1526** · the Lodis are the first **AFGHAN** dynasty, the rest Turkish · the Sultanate was **permanently short of legitimacy and permanently at war** - with Mongols, southern kingdoms and its own nobility, and **almost every institution answers one of those three**

SLAVE DYNASTY QUTB-UD-DIN AIBAK founder 1206, **began the QUTB MINAR**, Adhai din ka Jhompra, capital Lahore · **ILTUTMISH** the real consolidator - capital to **DELHI**, completed the **Qutb Minar**, silver **TANKA** + copper **JITAL**, organised the **IQTA** system, created the **CHALISA (Turkan-i-Chihalgani)** of forty nobles · **RAZIYA** the only woman ruler, nominated over Iltutmish's sons, deposed by the Turkish nobility · **BALBAN "blood and iron"** - broke the **Chalisa**, enforced **SIJDA** and **PAIBOS**, kingship as **divine deputyship**, created the **DIWAN-I-ARZ**

ALAUDDIN KHALJI 1296-1316 - the Sultanate's most examinable set, and **ONE** programme with **ONE purpose: fund and control a standing army** · **MARKET REGULATIONS** - state-fixed prices on grain, cloth, horses, cattle, slaves; enforced by the **DIWAN-I-RIYASAT** under the **Shahna-i-Mandi**; state granaries and compulsory sale in the doab · **the purpose was MILITARY SUPPLY, not consumer welfare** · **standing army paid in CASH** · **DAGH** horse-branding and **CHEHRA** soldier's descriptive roll - anti-fraud muster verification · **land revenue ~1/2 in the doab by measurement, khuts and muqaddams stripped of privilege** · nobles restricted, **barids** and spies · refused guidance from the ulema · conquests Gujarat, Ranthambore, Chittor, Malwa; **MALIK KAFUR** into the far south; built **ALAI DARWAZA, Siri, Hauz Khas**; **repelled repeated Mongol invasions** · the reforms collapsed at his death - a system of personal control, not institutions

MUHAMMAD-BIN-TUGHLAQ 1325-1351 - four experiments, and do NOT call him mad (1) capital to **DAULATABAD** and back · (2) **TOKEN CURRENCY** of brass and copper at silver value, withdrawn after uncontrollable forgery · (3) **KHURASAN expedition** abandoned · (4) **DIWAN-I-KOHI** agriculture department · **IBN BATTUTA** served as his qazi · raised doab taxation in famine · **the defensible verdict: sound objectives, consistently poor implementation - several transformations at once, on inadequate capacity, with no pilots and no reversibility**. Token currency is **fiat money**, and the missing element was an **enforceable monopoly on issue**, not a flaw in the idea

FIROZ SHAH TUGHLAQ 1351-1388 irrigation **CANALS**, the Sultanate's largest public works · founded **Firozabad, Hisar, Fatehabad, Jaunpur** · **DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT** charity, **Diwan-i-Bandagan** slaves, employment bureau · **Futuh-i-Firozshahi** · moved two **ASHOKAN PILLARS** to Delhi · **BUT: levied JIZYA on Brahmins for the first time, and made IQTAS HEREDITARY** - which converted servants into a landed aristocracy

LATER SULTANATE SAYYID founded by **Khizr Khan**, asked only for its position · **BAHLUL LODI** founds the Afghan line · **SIKANDAR LODI FOUNDED AGRA IN 1504** · **IBRAHIM LODI** killed at **FIRST PANIPAT 1526**

SULTANATE ADMINISTRATION WAZIR heads the **DIWAN-I-WIZARAT** (revenue and finance), the top office after the Sultan · **ARIZ-I-MUMALIK** heads the **DIWAN-I-ARZ** (military) · **DIWAN-I-INSHA** chancery · **DIWAN-I-RISALAT** religious/foreign · **SADR-US-SUDUR** religious head, often chief **QAZI** · **BARID** intelligence · **KOTWAL** city police - **the office survives into the Mughal period and into the modern word** · **IQTA** = revenue assignment in place of salary, holder an **iqtdar/muqti**; **Iltutmish systematised it, Firoz Shah made it hereditary** · taxes **KHARAJ** land revenue, **JIZYA** on non-Muslims, **ZAKAT** on Muslims, **KHAMS** one-fifth of spoils

SULTANATE SOURCES ZIAUDDIN BARANI - *Tarikh-i-Firozshahi*, partisan and read critically · **Minhaj-us-Siraj** - *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri* · **AMIR KHUSRAU**, also central to Hindustani music · **IBN BATTUTA** - *Rehla* · Isami - *Futuh-us-Salatin* · **these are court chronicles by men dependent on patronage, so a chronicler's judgement is evidence about the chronicler**

THE DECCAN BAHMANI 1347-1527, Gulbarga then **BIDAR**, founded by **Alauddin Bahman Shah**; greatest figure the minister **MAHMUD GAWAN**, executed on a forged charge, after which it declined · **broke into FIVE SULTANATES: BIJAPUR (Adil Shahi) · GOLCONDA (Qutb Shahi) · AHMADNAGAR (Nizam Shahi) · BERAR (Imad Shahi) · BIDAR (Barid Shahi)**

VIJAYANAGARA 1336-1646, capital **Vijayanagara = HAMPI** · founded by **HARIHARA and BUKKA**, Sangama dynasty · **four dynasties in order: SANGAMA → SALUVA → TULUVA → ARAVIDU** · greatest ruler **KRISHNADEVARAYA** (Tuluva), wrote the **AMUKTAMALYADA** in Telugu, patronised the **ASHTADIGGAJAS** · accounts by **Domingo Paes, Nuniz, Abdur Razzaq** · **AMARA-NAYAKA** military land system · **BATTLE OF TALIKOTA 1565** - the Deccan sultanates' coalition destroys it, and the ruins are F5.5's Hampi

MUGHALS - BABUR to HUMAYUN **BABUR 1526-1530**, Timurid, **Timur** on his father's side and **Genghis** on his mother's · **FIRST PANIPAT 1526 v Ibrahim Lodi** (won on **field artillery and the tulughma**, not numbers) · **KHANWA 1527 v RANA SANGA** - **mattered more than Panipat** · **Ghaghra 1529** · **BABURNAMA** in **TURKISH (Chaghatai)** · **HUMAYUN** lost to **SHER SHAH** at **CHAUSA 1539** and **KANNAUJ 1540**, exiled to Persia, **recovered Delhi 1555**, died 1556

SHER SHAH SURI 1540-1545 - **asked out of all proportion, because Akbar inherited his template revenue by SURVEY and MEASUREMENT** · **PATTA** (state's statement of holding and liability) and **QABULIYAT** (cultivator's deed of acceptance) · **introduced the silver RUPIYA** - ancestor of the modern rupee - and the copper **DAM** · **rebuilt the GRAND TRUNK ROAD** with **SARIS** doubling as **DAK** stages · **Rohtasgarh fort, tomb at SASARAM** · divisions **sarkar** and **pargana**

AKBAR 1556-1605 acceded at **13** under **BAIRAM KHAN** · **SECOND PANIPAT 1556 v HEMU** · Rajput policy by alliance, but **MEWAR** under **RANA PRATAP** resisted at **HALDIGHATI 1576** · **abolished JIZYA 1564** · **SULH-I-KUL**, the **IBADAT KHANA**, and **DIN-I-ILAH** - a small personal order of discipleship, **NOT a religion, and it died with him** · **MANSABDARI** and **TODAR MAL's ZABTI/DAHSALA** · **ABUL FAZL's AKBARNAMA**, third volume the **AIN-I-AKBARI**

JAHANGIR to AURANGZEB **JAHANGIR 1605-1627** - **NUR JAHAN**, the **chain of justice**, **HAWKINS** then **Sir THOMAS ROE** get trading concessions (**the start of the English presence, and the link to F5.9**), the peak of Mughal painting under **USTAD MANSUR** · **SHAH JAHAN 1628-1658** - **TAJ MAHAL**, **Red Fort**, **Jama Masjid**, **Peacock Throne**, capital **Shahjahanabad**; cultural zenith and the beginning of fiscal strain; deposed after a war of succession · **AURANGZEB 1658-1707**, titled **Alamgir** - **re-imposed JIZYA 1679**, annexed **BIJAPUR 1686** and **GOLCONDA 1687**, **25 years of inconclusive Deccan war against the Marathas**, executed **Guru Tegh Bahadur**; his death in **1707** ends effective Mughal power · **the defensible verdict on him: his policies narrowed the base Akbar deliberately widened, and the Deccan wars exhausted the empire - structural damage as much as sectarian**

MUGHAL INSTITUTIONS - the chapter's central idea **MANSABDARI**: every officer holds a **mansab** with **ZAT** (personal rank and pay) and **SAWAR** (cavalry to maintain) · **NOT hereditary, granted and revoked by the emperor** · paid in cash (**naqdi**) or by **JAGIR**, which assigns **revenue only, not land ownership**, and is **transferable** · **dagh** continues from Alauddin · **ZABTI/DAHSALA (TODAR MAL)**: land measured and classified, revenue set on the **average yield and prices of the preceding TEN YEARS**, stated in cash and fixed in advance · land classes **POLAJ, PARAUTI, CHACHAR, BANJAR** · **together they solved the two problems that destroyed the Sultanate - overmighty nobles and unpredictable income** · offices **DIWAN-I-ALA** finance, **MIR BAKHSI** military pay and mansab records, **MIR SAMAN** household and karkhanas, **SADR-US-SUDUR** religion, **QAZI-UL-QUZAT** chief judge · provinces **SUBAH (subedar) → SARKAR (faujdar) → PARGANA (amil)**, and the **KOTWAL** in towns

THE MARATHAS SHIVAJI 1630-1680, crowned **CHHATRAPATI** at **RAIGAD 1674** · killed **Afzal Khan**, raided **Shaista Khan**, **Treaty of Purandar 1665**, escaped from **Agra 1666** · guerrilla war (**ganimi kava**), hill forts, a navy - **often called the father of the Indian navy** · **ASHTAPRADHAN** council of eight headed by the **PESHTWA** · taxes **CHAUTH** ~1/4 and **SARDESHMUKHI** ~1/10 on territory outside direct rule · **Sambhaji** executed by Aurangzeb · under **Balaji Vishwanath** and **BAJI RAO I** the **PESHTWA** becomes hereditary and the real power, the Chhatrapati a figurehead at Satara · **THIRD PANIPAT 1761** - **AHMAD SHAH ABDALI** destroys their bid for northern supremacy

THE THREE PANIPATS 1526 Babur beats Ibrahim Lodi · **1556 Akbar's** forces beat Hemu · **1761 Abdali** beats the Marathas - one place, three battles, three centuries

WHY THE MUGHALS DECLINED - FIVE the DECCAN WARS drained treasury, army and the emperor's presence · **the JAGIR/MANSAB CRISIS** - **be-jagiri**, more nobles than jagirs, and paper value exceeding real yield, so **loyalty followed the money** · **agrarian strain and revolt** - Jat, Satnami, Sikh · **a narrowed political base** after the reversal of sulh-i-kul · **weak successors and contested succession** - **NO law of primogeniture**, and the **Sayyid brothers** making and unmaking emperors · accelerants **NADIR SHAH's sack of Delhi 1739** (Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor) and **Abdali's invasions** · **structural summary: the empire converted land revenue into loyal military service and failed when revenue could no longer cover the service** - and across **F5.3, F5.4** and **F5.7** the same pattern holds, that institutions outlast individuals only if they remain solvent

8. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F5.7 - MEDIEVAL INDIA

SLAVE 1206-1290 → KHALJI 1290-1320 → TUGHLAQ 1320-1414 → SAYYID 1414-1451 → LODI 1451-1526

AIBAK founder, BEGAN Qutb Minar · ILTUTMISH consolidator, COMPLETED it, TANKA + JITAL, IQTA, CHALISA

**RAZIYA the only woman ruler · BALBAN: SIJDA + PAIBOS, broke the Chalisa, Diwan-i-Arz
ALAUDDIN KHALJI: MARKET REGULATIONS via DIWAN-I-RIYASAT - to fund a CASH-PAID
STANDING ARMY**

DAGH = horse branding · CHEHRA = soldier's roll · revenue ~1/2 doab · MALIK KAFUR to the south

ALAI DARWAZA, Siri, Hauz Khas · repelled the MONGOLS · his reforms died with him

**MBT: DAULATABAD capital · TOKEN CURRENCY (fiat, failed on forgery) · KHURASAN ·
DIWAN-I-KOHI**

**FIROZ SHAH: CANALS, DIWAN-I-KHAIRAT, 2 ASHOKAN PILLARS · BUT jizya on Brahmins +
IQTAS HEREDITARY**

SIKANDAR LODI FOUNDED AGRA 1504 · IBRAHIM LODI died at FIRST PANIPAT 1526

BARID = intelligence · KOTWAL = city police · KHARAJ, JIZYA, ZAKAT, KHAMS (1/5 spoils)

**BAHMANI 1347-1527, Gulbarga then BIDAR · MAHMUD GAWAN the great minister,
executed**

**FIVE DECCAN SULTANATES: BIJAPUR Adil Shahi · GOLCONDA Qutb Shahi · AHMADNAGAR
Nizam Shahi · BERAR Imad Shahi · BIDAR Barid Shahi**

VIJAYANAGARA 1336: HARIHARA + BUKKA · SANGAMA → SALUVA → TULUVA → ARAVIDU

KRISHNADEVARAYA (Tuluva) wrote AMUKTAMALYADA, patron of the ASHTADIGGAJAS

TALIKOTA 1565 - the Deccan sultanates' COALITION destroys Vijayanagara · ruins = HAMPI

**BABUR: PANIPAT I 1526 · KHANWA 1527 v RANA SANGA (mattered more) · BABURNAMA in
TURKISH**

**SHER SHAH: RUPIYA + dam · GRAND TRUNK ROAD + SARAIS · PATTA + QABULIYAT · tomb
at SASARAM**

AKBAR: PANIPAT II 1556 v HEMU · BAIRAM KHAN regent · JIZYA ABOLISHED 1564

**SULH-I-KUL · IBADAT KHANA · DIN-I-ILAH = a tiny order of discipleship, NOT a religion,
died with him**

**HALDIGHATI 1576 v RANA PRATAP · ABUL FAZL: AKBARNAMA + AIN-I-AKBARI · TODAR
MAL: ZABTI**

JAHANGIR: NUR JAHAN, chain of justice, THOMAS ROE, painting peak (USTAD MANSUR)

SHAH JAHAN: TAJ MAHAL, Red Fort, PEACOCK THRONE, Shahjahanabad

**AURANGZEB: JIZYA RE-IMPOSED 1679 · BIJAPUR 1686 + GOLCONDA 1687 · 25 yrs of Deccan
war · d. 1707**

**MANSABDARI: ZAT = rank/pay, SAWAR = cavalry · NOT hereditary · JAGIR = REVENUE only,
transferable**

DAHSALA: average yield + prices of TEN YEARS · POLAJ, PARAUTI, CHACHAR, BANJAR

**SHIVAJI: CHHATRAPATI at RAIGAD 1674 · ASHTAPRADHAN under the PESHWA · ganimi
kava**

CHAUTH ~1/4 · SARDESHMUKHI ~1/10 · PESHWA becomes hereditary under BAJI RAO I

THREE PANIPATS: 1526 Babur-Lodi · 1556 Akbar-Hemu · 1761 ABDALI-MARATHAS

**DECLINE: Deccan wars · BE-JAGIRI · agrarian revolt · narrowed base · no PRIMOGENITURE ·
NADIR SHAH 1739**

**ANCHOR DATES 1526 · 1556 · 1565 · 1707 - the empire failed when revenue stopped
covering service**